Hiring & Team Building Kit

Recruit, Onboard, and Retain Great People

A ZANDER SYSTEMS PUBLICATION

Operating Simply Methodology

$99

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01

Job Description Templates

10+ roles ready to post

Hiring & Team Building Kit

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Interview Question Banks

Structured interviews that work

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03

Interview Scorecards

Objective candidate evaluation

1. Building Your Hiring Foundation
2. Job Description Templates
3. The Interview System
4. Onboarding Checklists
5. Performance Framework
6. Team Culture Building
7. Retention Strategies
8. HR Compliance Essentials

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The 30-60-90 Onboarding System

Set new hires up for success

Before You Hire: The Position Audit

Before posting any job, answer these questions:

Is this hire necessary?

- Can existing team members cover this work?
- Can we outsource or automate instead?
- What happens if we don't hire?

What does success look like?

- What will this person accomplish in 90 days?
- What will they own in 1 year?
- How will we measure their performance?

What's the real budget impact?

```
TOTAL COST OF HIRE
____________________________________________________
Base Salary: $_____
Benefits (typically 20-30%): $_____
Payroll taxes (7.65%): $_____
Equipment & workspace: $_____
Training time cost: $_____
Recruiting costs: $_____
____________________________________________________
Total First Year Cost: $_____
```

The Ideal Candidate Profile

Go beyond the resume. Define who you actually need:

Checklist

- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____

- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____

Compensation Philosophy

Decide your approach before you start:

APPROACH	DESCRIPTION	BEST FOR
Above Market	Pay 75th percentile+	High-growth, competitive roles
At Market	Pay 50th percentile	Most roles, stable growth
Below Market + Equity	Lower base, ownership stake	Startups, believers in mission
Performance Heavy	Lower base, high variable	Sales, revenue-driving roles

Resources for market data:

- Glassdoor
- LinkedIn Salary
- Levels.fyi (tech)
- PayScale
- Industry associations

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Performance Review Templates

Fair, consistent feedback

The Job Description Framework

Every job description should include:

1. **Hook** - Why this role matters (2-3 sentences)
2. **About Us** - Company context (keep it short)
3. **What You'll Do** - 5-8 key responsibilities
4. **What You Bring** - Requirements (musts vs. nice-to-haves)
5. **What We Offer** - Compensation and benefits
6. **How to Apply** - Clear next step

Sample: Operations Manager

```
OPERATIONS MANAGER
──────────────────────────────────────────────────

YOUR IMPACT
We're looking for an Operations Manager who will be the
backbone of our growing team. You'll build the systems
that let us scale while maintaining the quality our
customers expect.

ABOUT [COMPANY]
[2-3 sentences about company, mission, and stage]

WHAT YOU'LL DO
• Design and optimize operational processes across the
  company, reducing friction and increasing efficiency
• Manage vendor relationships and negotiate contracts
  to improve terms and reduce costs by 15%+
• Build and maintain documentation for all core processes,
  creating our operational playbook
• Lead weekly operations review, identifying bottlenecks
  and implementing solutions
• Manage office operations, facilities, and equipment
• Support hiring, onboarding, and HR administration
• Own key metrics dashboard and report to leadership

WHAT YOU BRING
Required:
• 3+ years in operations, project management, or similar
• Track record of building processes from scratch
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• Strong analytical skills with Excel/Google Sheets
• Excellent written and verbal communication
• Experience managing vendors or external partners

Nice to Have:
• Experience in [industry] or similar fast-paced environment
• Familiarity with tools like Notion, Asana, or Monday.com
• PMP or other relevant certification

WHAT WE OFFER
• Competitive salary: $[X] - $[Y] based on experience
• Health, dental, and vision insurance
• 401(k) with [X]% company match
• Unlimited PTO (with minimum usage requirement)
• Professional development budget
• Flexible work arrangements

HOW TO APPLY
Send your resume and a brief note explaining why you're
interested to [email]. In your note, please share an
example of a process you built or improved.
```

Sample: Sales Representative

```
SALES REPRESENTATIVE
____________________________________________________

YOUR IMPACT
Join our sales team and directly drive the revenue that
fuels our mission. You'll own the full sales cycle from
prospecting to close, working with [target customers].

ABOUT [COMPANY]
[2-3 sentences about company, mission, and stage]

WHAT YOU'LL DO
• Generate new business through outbound prospecting
  (50+ calls/emails per day)
• Qualify inbound leads and convert to opportunities
• Conduct product demonstrations and discovery calls
• Manage full sales cycle: qualify, demo, propose, negotiate, close
• Maintain accurate pipeline in CRM with regular updates
• Meet or exceed monthly quota of $[X] in new revenue
• Collaborate with marketing on campaign feedback
• Represent company at industry events and trade shows

WHAT YOU BRING
Required:
• 2+ years B2B sales experience with quota responsibility
• Track record of meeting/exceeding targets
```

```
• Strong phone presence and communication skills
• Experience with CRM systems (Salesforce, HubSpot, etc.)
• Self-motivated with ability to work independently
• Coachable with growth mindset

Nice to Have:
• Experience in [industry]
• Existing network in target customer segment
• Experience with [specific tools]

COMPENSATION
• Base salary: $[X] - $[Y]
• On-target earnings (OTE): $[X] - $[Y]
• Commission: [X]% on new business, paid [monthly/quarterly]
• Accelerators for exceeding quota
• Full benefits package

HOW TO APPLY
Send your resume to [email] with subject line
"Sales Rep - [Your Name]". Include your quota performance
from your last 2 roles (% to target).
```

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Team Building Activities

Culture beyond ping pong tables

The Structured Interview Process

Consistency is key. Every candidate should experience:

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INTERVIEW STAGES
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Stage 1: Phone Screen (20-30 min)
  - Basic qualifications
  - Salary expectations
  - Timeline and logistics
  - Cultural fit indicators

Stage 2: Skills Assessment (30-60 min)
  - Role-specific test or case study
  - Technical skills verification
  - Problem-solving approach

Stage 3: Team Interview (45-60 min)
  - Deeper dive with hiring manager
  - Cross-functional team members
  - Culture fit assessment

Stage 4: Final Interview (30-45 min)
  - Executive/senior leadership
  - Final questions and concerns
  - Sell the opportunity

Reference Checks (after verbal offer acceptance)
  - 2-3 professional references
  - Verify claims and fit
```

Phone Screen Questions

```
PHONE SCREEN SCRIPT
──────────────────────────────────────────────────

Opening:
"Thanks for taking the time today. This is an initial
conversation to learn more about your background and share
about the role. I have about 20 minutes—does that work?"

Questions:
1. Walk me through your background and how you got to
```

```
   where you are today.

2. What attracted you to this opportunity?

3. Tell me about your current/most recent role. What
   were your primary responsibilities?

4. What are you looking for in your next position?

5. What are your salary expectations for this role?

6. What's your timeline? Are you interviewing elsewhere?

7. What questions do you have about the role or company?

Close:
"Thanks for sharing. Here's what happens next:
[Explain next steps and timeline]"
```

Behavioral Interview Questions

Use the STAR method: Situation, Task, Action, Result

Leadership/Management:

- Tell me about a time you had to deliver difficult feedback.
- Describe a situation where you motivated a struggling team member.
- Give an example of a decision you made that was unpopular.

Problem-Solving:

- Walk me through how you approached a complex problem.
- Tell me about a time you had to make a decision with incomplete information.
- Describe a project that didn't go as planned. What happened?

Collaboration:

- Give an example of a successful cross-functional project you led.
- Tell me about a time you disagreed with a colleague. How did you resolve it?
- Describe how you've built relationships with stakeholders.

Results/Achievement:

- What's the accomplishment you're most proud of?
- Tell me about a time you exceeded expectations.
- Describe a goal you set and how you achieved it.

Scoring Rubric

Rate candidates consistently:

SCORE	DEFINITION
5	Exceptional - Exceeds all requirements, immediate impact
4	Strong - Meets all requirements, some exceed
3	Acceptable - Meets most requirements
2	Weak - Missing key requirements
1	Poor - Does not meet requirements

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Culture Documentation

Define who you are

Pre-Start Checklist (HR/Manager)

1 Week Before Start:

Checklist

- [ ] Offer letter signed and filed
- [ ] Background check complete (if applicable)
- [ ] Equipment ordered and configured
- [ ] Accounts created (email, systems, etc.)
- [ ] Workspace prepared
- [ ] Onboarding schedule created
- [ ] Welcome announcement drafted
- [ ] Day 1 buddy assigned
- [ ] First week meetings scheduled

Day 1 Checklist

Checklist

- [ ] Greeted at arrival by manager or buddy
- [ ] Workspace tour and introductions
- [ ] Equipment and access confirmed

- [ ] HR paperwork completed (I-9, W-4, benefits enrollment)
- [ ] Emergency contact and policies reviewed
- [ ] 1:1 with direct manager
- [ ] Meet key team members
- [ ] Review company handbook
- [ ] Access all needed systems and tools
- [ ] End-of-day check-in

First Week Checklist

Checklist

- [ ] Deep dive on company: history, mission, values
- [ ] Product/service overview
- [ ] Shadow team members
- [ ] Begin training modules
- [ ] Meet cross-functional partners
- [ ] Review key processes and documentation
- [ ] Continue training
- [ ] First small assignment
- [ ] Customer overview (who we serve, why)
- [ ] Tools and systems training
- [ ] Progress check with manager

- [ ] Week 1 review with manager
- [ ] Clarify questions and concerns
- [ ] Set Week 2 priorities
- [ ] Feedback on onboarding experience

30-60-90 Day Plan Template

Checklist

- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____

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The Hiring Flowchart

Process from posting to offer

Goal Setting (OKRs)

Objectives: What you want to achieve (qualitative) **Key Results:** How you'll measure it (quantitative)

```
OKR TEMPLATE
____________________________________________________

Quarter: Q[X] [Year]
Employee: _______________

OBJECTIVE 1: _______________
KR 1.1: _______________
KR 1.2: _______________
KR 1.3: _______________

OBJECTIVE 2: _______________
KR 2.1: _______________
KR 2.2: _______________

OBJECTIVE 3: _______________
KR 3.1: _______________
KR 3.2: _______________
```

1:1 Meeting Framework

Weekly or biweekly, 30-45 minutes

```
1:1 AGENDA
____________________________________________________

1. Employee updates (10 min)
   - What's going well?
   - What's challenging?
   - Any blockers I can help with?

2. Priority alignment (10 min)
   - Progress on goals
   - Shifting priorities
   - Resources needed

3. Development (5 min)
   - Skills growth
   - Career aspirations
   - Feedback (both directions)
```

```
4. Anything else (5 min)
   - Open discussion
   - Questions
   - Action items recap
```

Performance Review Template

```
PERFORMANCE REVIEW
_____________________________________________________

Employee: _______________
Review Period: _______________
Manager: _______________

OVERALL RATING: [Exceptional/Strong/Meets/Developing/Below]

GOAL ACHIEVEMENT (40%)
_____________________________________________________

Goal 1: _______________
Achievement: [0-100%]
Comments: _______________

Goal 2: _______________
Achievement: [0-100%]
Comments: _______________

CORE COMPETENCIES (40%)
_____________________________________________________

Competency 1: [Rating 1-5]
Examples: _______________

Competency 2: [Rating 1-5]
Examples: _______________

VALUES ALIGNMENT (20%)
_____________________________________________________

[Value 1]: [Rating 1-5]
Examples: _______________

STRENGTHS
_____________________________________________

AREAS FOR DEVELOPMENT
_____________________________________________

GOALS FOR NEXT PERIOD
1. _______________
2. _______________
3. _______________
```

```
EMPLOYEE COMMENTS
_____________________________________________

SIGNATURES
Employee: _______________ Date: _______
Manager: _______________ Date: _______
```

Defining Your Culture

Culture isn't ping pong tables and free snacks. It's how people behave when no one's watching.

The Culture Canvas:

```
CULTURE DEFINITION
_____________________________________________________

Our Mission: _______________

Our Core Values:
1. _______________ (Example behavior: _______________)
2. _______________ (Example behavior: _______________)
3. _______________ (Example behavior: _______________)

We hire people who: _______________

We don't hire people who: _______________

The best thing about working here: _______________

What outsiders don't understand: _______________
```

Team Rituals

Build connection through consistent practices:

Daily:

- Morning standup (15 min max)
- End-of-day wins channel

Weekly:

- Team meeting with rotating facilitator
- Learning share (someone teaches something)
- Friday wins celebration

Monthly:

- All-hands meeting
- Social event (optional, but offered)

- Birthday/milestone recognition

Quarterly:

- Offsite or team building
- Strategy review
- Individual career conversations

Annually:

- Company retreat
- Annual review and goal setting
- Service day or volunteering

Recognition Programs

Peer Recognition:

- Slack channel for shoutouts
- Monthly peer-nominated awards
- Value-based recognition cards

Manager Recognition:

- Spot bonuses for exceptional work
- Public acknowledgment in meetings
- Written notes of appreciation

Company Recognition:

- Quarterly top performer awards
- Anniversary celebrations
- Promotion announcements

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Why People Leave

Exit interview data consistently shows:

1. **Manager relationship** (most common)
2. **Career growth** - No clear path forward
3. **Compensation** - Fell behind market
4. **Work-life balance** - Burnout
5. **Culture fit** - Values misalignment

Retention Levers

Career Development:

- Clear advancement paths
- Regular career conversations
- Learning and development budget
- Stretch assignments
- Mentorship programs

Compensation:

- Annual market analysis
- Merit increases tied to performance
- Equity refresh (if applicable)
- Retention bonuses for key roles

Work Environment:

- Flexible work options
- Manager training
- Workload management
- Team health monitoring

Engagement:

- Regular feedback loops

- Recognition programs
- Social connection opportunities
- Involvement in decisions

Stay Interview Questions

Don't wait for exit interviews. Ask current employees:

1. What do you look forward to at work?
2. What's one thing that might tempt you to leave?
3. What talent do you have that we're not using?
4. What would you change about your job?
5. When was the last time you thought about leaving? What caused it?

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Employment Law Checklist

At Hire:

Checklist

- [ ] I-9 completed within 3 days
- [ ] W-4 completed
- [ ] State tax forms if applicable
- [ ] Employee handbook acknowledgment
- [ ] At-will employment acknowledgment
- [ ] Non-compete/NDA if applicable
- [ ] Direct deposit authorization
- [ ] Emergency contact form

Ongoing:

Checklist

- [ ] Wage and hour compliance (overtime, breaks)
- [ ] Anti-discrimination policies
- [ ] Harassment prevention training
- [ ] Safety training (OSHA compliance)

- [ ] Workers' compensation coverage
- [ ] Unemployment insurance
- [ ] ADA accommodations process
- [ ] FMLA tracking if applicable (50+ employees)

At Termination:

Checklist

- [ ] Final paycheck timing (check state law)
- [ ] Benefits continuation (COBRA)
- [ ] Exit interview conducted
- [ ] Equipment returned
- [ ] Access revoked
- [ ] Reference policy communicated
- [ ] Unemployment claim preparation

Required Postings

Display in workplace:

- Federal minimum wage
- OSHA workplace safety
- EEO is the Law
- FMLA (if applicable)
- State-specific postings

Documentation Best Practices

Always document:

- Performance issues and conversations
- Accommodations requests and responses
- Complaints and investigations
- Policy violations and consequences
- Positive recognition too

Keep records for:

- I-9: 3 years after hire or 1 year after termination
- Personnel files: 7 years after termination
- Payroll records: 7 years
- Benefits records: 6 years

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Included in this kit:

1. Job Description Template (Word)
2. Interview Scorecard (Excel)
3. Offer Letter Template (Word)
4. Onboarding Checklist (Excel)
5. 30-60-90 Day Plan (Word)
6. Performance Review Template (Word)
7. 1:1 Meeting Agenda (Notion/PDF)
8. Exit Interview Questions (Word)

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Building a great team is one of the 10 pillars of Operating Simply. We help businesses create systems for hiring, developing, and retaining top talent.

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